

Business Insights

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DSA3050A Mid-Semester Exam

Dashboard: Global Development & Investment Risk Dashboard - Economic, Social & Environmental Indicators by Country (World Bank World Development Indicators dataset)

Insight 1: Infrastructure Gap in Developing Economies

The dashboard shows that Developing nations make up the largest share of countries tracked (25.37%) yet display markedly lower average electricity access compared to Developed nations. For an investment fund evaluating frontier markets, this signals an infrastructure gap that represents both a risk factor (unreliable power affecting business operations) and a potential opportunity (infrastructure investment demand) in these economies.

Insight 2: Rising Global Emissions Increase Long-Term ESG Exposure

The CO2 Emissions Trend line chart shows a consistent upward trajectory in global emissions from approximately 2000 to 2020, with no signs of plateauing. This trend implies that countries and companies operating within these economies face rising exposure to future carbon regulation and environmental compliance costs, a material consideration for any long-horizon investment thesis with ESG mandates.

Insight 3: Electricity Access and Emissions Move Together in Early Industrialization

The scatter plot of Electricity Access vs. CO2 Emissions shows a clear positive relationship: countries expanding electricity access tend to also show higher emissions, consistent with energy-intensive early-stage industrialization. This suggests that as emerging and developing economies close their infrastructure gap (Insight 1), their emissions profile will likely worsen before stabilizing, reinforcing the importance of pairing infrastructure investment with renewable energy strategy in these markets.